

Investing

1. Index funds allow purchases of entire markets or sectors cheaply.
2. ETFs allow funds to be purchased intraday, and operate without unintentional capital gains taxes.
3. Expense ratios have plummeted; costs are much lower.
4. Investor behavior has become much better understood.
5. More market data is broadly available than ever before.
6. Factors that drive returns are well catalogued.
7. Digital platforms allow professional management regardless of account size.
8. Tax-loss harvesting increases net returns for investors.
9. Portfolios can be tailored to reflect an investor's personal values.
10. Direct indexing gives investors enormous flexibility.

Trading

1. Costs have dropped to zero.
2. Trades clear and settle much faster, with next-day settlement (T+1).
3. Apps allow access to markets via mobile devices.
4. Analytic tools are ubiquitous.
5. Market and company information is available instantaneously.

Banking

1. Apps (Venmo) allow individuals to send cash as easily as texting.
2. Square allows vendors of any size to process credit card transactions.